attacks in Pakistan during the latter years of the decade.[37] It was linked to al-Qaeda as well as various pro-Taliban militants, and comprised of anti-statist members from a number of different outfits.

Despite the advent of desertions and internal disputes, Lashkar remained the most organizationally intact and coherent jihadi outfit in Pakistan in the years after 9/11. This meant that in addition to receiving better treatment by the state than any other outfit, it was also better positioned to maximize its freedom of movement. Lashkar not only shared the Musharraf regime's focus on India, its leaders also surmised that remaining close to the state was the best means of maintaining influence in the long term. Because JuD remained legal, this provided a means to augment its strength and resources as well as to increase its societal standing. As JuD consolidated and expanded its support base among the populace, this strengthened the government's case for refusing to ban it, even as the group leveraged its legality to support militant activities against India as well as the West. Yet, although Lashkar's behavior after 9/11 was Janus-like, it was careful to show only one face publicly.

Good Jihadi

The group gave even greater weight to the provision of social services after Lashkar's ban in early 2002 and the cosmetic separation from JuD that immediately preceded it. JuD's departments essentially mirrored those that existed as part of the prodigious MDI infrastructure, but post-2002 they became even more robust and the scope as well as the scale of their offerings increased.[38] So too did the group's reputation as an organization that 'looks out for you not only with money, but with education, health, house-building, dispute arbitration, whatever you need' according to one prominent Pakistani journalist.[39] Increasingly, what Pakistanis saw in terms of its public behavior was not militancy as much as social work and religious activism and when the group did promote jihad, it was mainly against India. One former member claimed that despite 'belonging to the Salafi sect, Lashkar has [the] sympathies of people from all sects [in Pakistan] because of its social work and because it has focused on jihad against India and does not kill innocent people in Pakistan.'[40]